

Da Lat → Mui Ne → Saigon

8 - 12 September 2026

Haris Haikal & Aina Izzaty · Malaysia Airlines both ways · two nights of driving, no flying in between Da Lat in two days and one night, the dunes for two, Saigon for the last.

The Five Days

DAY	DATE	WHERE	THE POINT OF THE DAY	OUTFIT
Day 1	Tue, 8 Sep	Fly in → Da Lat	Lake, L'angfarm, night market	Soft blue + brown
Day 2	Wed, 9 Sep	Da Lat → Mui Ne	Dawn clouds, hydrangeas, coaster, then the pass	Black leather am · pink + white
Day 3	Thu, 10 Sep	Mui Ne	White dunes at sunrise, Fairy Stream, beach	Blue + yellow
Day 4	Fri, 11 Sep	Mui Ne → Saigon	Café apartment, post office, Bến Thành	Cream fairytale
Day 5	Sat, 12 Sep	Fly home	Taxi to the airport, nothing else	Khaki + black

Book Tonight, In This Order

- 1 Ask Malaysia Airlines to reroute the CGK ticket to Saigon**
MAS flies KUL-Saigon ~7 times a day (MH750 / MH758 / MH766). If they cancel Jakarta, ask to be moved to Saigon rather than refunded. +60 3-7843-3000
- 2 MAS KUL → SGN on 8 Sept (morning), SGN → KUL on 12 Sept (afternoon)**
Only the outbound needs a domestic connection — the way home is a straight flight from Saigon.
- 3 Domestic: SGN → Da Lat on 8 Sept**
Vietnam Airlines or Vietjet, 55 min, six a day, last one 17:30. Leave three hours to connect.
- 4 Two private cars, booked ahead**
9 Sept: Da Lat → Mui Ne on **QL28B** (155 km, 3.5-4h), pickup 12.45. 11 Sept: Mui Ne → Saigon on the expressway (2.5-3h), pickup ~10.30.
- 5 Hotels: 1 night Da Lat (8th), 2 nights Mui Ne (9-10), 1 night Saigon (11th)**
Da Lat central; Mui Ne on the Ham Tien beach strip; Saigon in District 1 near Nguyen Hue.
- 6 A car for Day 2 morning and Day 3 sunrise**
Day 2 needs an **04.40 pickup** for the cloud hunt; Day 3 an 04.30 for the white dunes. The Mui Ne hotel can arrange a jeep.
- 7 Cancel or move the Bandung bookings**
Holiday Inn Pasteur, Swiss-Belresort Dago, Fairfield CGK — ask for a waiver citing the airport closure. Message Kiki.
- 8 Insurance, eSIM, offline maps**
Re-issue for Vietnam; keep the Bandung paperwork for the claim.

Good To Know

Visa Visa-free for Malaysians, 30 days. Carry hotel bookings and onward tickets.	Three climates Da Lat 17-24°C and cool at dawn; Mui Ne 25-31°C and bright; Saigon 30°C+ and humid.	Weather honesty Mui Ne is one of Vietnam's driest regions but September still averages ~217 mm over ~20 days — lighter and shorter than elsewhere, not dry.
Money Vietnamese dong. Cash for dune jeeps, market bargaining and small cafés.	Getting around Grab in Da Lat and Saigon. In Mui Ne everything is on one strip — taxis and hotel cars.	Two early starts 05.00 on Days 2 and 3. Both are for light you cannot get later. The afternoons are deliberately empty.

MAS out: _____ SGN → DLI: _____ MAS home: _____ QL28B car: _____
Da Lat hotel: _____ Mui Ne hotel: _____ Saigon hotel: _____ *Checked 6 Sept 2026.*

DAY 1

Fly in — one evening in Da Lat

Tuesday, 8 September

START

Morning MAS from KLIA

FINISH

~21.30

SLEEP

Da Lat (1 night only)

Outfit: Soft blue + brown — café theme, and it's cool enough for layers

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
morning	KUL → SGN — Malaysia Airlines KLIA	~2h	MH750 / MH758 / MH766, about 7 a day. Take one landing in Saigon by early afternoon. Vietnam is 1 hour behind Malaysia .
~12.30	Connect at Tan Son Nhat Saigon — T2 international, T1 domestic	~3h	Separate tickets means collecting bags, walking to T1 and checking in again. Three hours is the safe margin.
~15.30	SGN → DLI — Vietnam Airlines or Vietjet Tan Son Nhat T1	55 min	Six a day, last departure 17:30. Book it the same day as the MAS leg.
Lien Khuong airport → Da Lat city — 30 km, ~40 min			
~17.30	Check in — Da Lat City centre, near the lake	45 min	One night only, so stay central and don't unpack properly.
~18.30	Xuan Huong Lake City centre Open in Google Maps	1h	The lake loop at dusk, lit up and busy with locals. Five minutes from anywhere central.
~19.45	Dinner + L'angfarm Center Da Lat centre	1.5h	Dried fruit, artichoke tea, jam, coffee, macadamia — buy the whole lot tonight, because you leave tomorrow. They vacuum-pack.
~21.15	Da Lat Night Market Cho Dem, centre Open in Google Maps	45 min	Right there and open late. Grilled corn, banh trang nuong, hot soy milk if you still have room.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- Da Lat is at 1,500 m — 17–24°C and about 17°C tonight. This is the only cold evening of the trip; the jacket earns its place today and tomorrow at dawn.
- Simpler alternative:** AirAsia flies KUL → Da Lat direct (AK571, 2h10) but only ~4 days a week. If 8 September is one, take it and skip Saigon entirely on the way in.
- Set the alarm for 04.30. Tomorrow starts in the dark and it's worth it.

DAY 2

Dawn clouds, hydrangeas, then the pass to the sea

Wednesday, 9 September

START
05.00FINISH
~21.00SLEEP
Move → Mui Ne (2 nights)

Outfit: Black leather + white for the 05.00 cloud hunt (it's cold) · change into **soft pink + white** after breakfast

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
05.00	Thác Mây & Chill — cloud hunting at dawn Đốc số 9, Trại Mát — 15–20 min east Open in Google Maps	2h	It opens at 05:00 exactly so you can watch cloud pour into the ravine below you at first light. Cold, dark, worth it. This is the leather-jacket hour.
~20 min back to the hotel			
~07.30	Breakfast + change Da Lat centre	1h	Swap into the pink and white for the flower stop.
~08.45	Suối Bình Yên + Hydrangea Street Hoa Cẩm Tú Cầu st, Ward 3 — 10–15 min out Open in Google Maps	1.5h	A stream-side garden café, deliberately slow — and it sits on Hydrangea Street , so the cẩm tú cầu fields are right there. They flower May to December, so they're out now.
~25 min south on QL20			
~10.45	Datanla — new alpine coaster QL20, ~5 km south Open in Google Maps	1.25h	The rebuilt coaster down through the forest, and the falls at the bottom. You control the brake. It's on the road out of town, so it costs you no detour.
~12.15	Lunch, then collect the bags Da Lat / Đức Trọng	45 min	Eat before the pass — there is not much on QL28B.
DRIVE: Da Lat → Mui Ne on QL28B over the Đại Ninh pass — 155 km, 3.5–4 hours			
~16.45	Drop bags — Mui Ne Mui Ne / Ham Tien beach strip	20 min	Straight in, bags down, back out. You're chasing the sunset.
~17.15	Red Sand Dunes (Đồi Hồng) for sunset ~10 min from the Mui Ne strip Open in Google Maps	1.5h	Orange dunes right by the road, best in the last hour of light. Kids rent plastic sleds; the dunes photograph far bigger than they are.
~19.30	Seafood dinner Mui Ne fishing-village end Open in Google Maps	1.5h	Pick from the tanks. Cheaper and better at the village end than on the resort strip.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- **Leave Da Lat by 12.45.** QL28B climbs down the Đại Ninh pass and you want it in daylight — it's a good road but a serious one.
- If the morning slips, drop Datanla. It's the one stop that isn't unique to this trip.
- You descend from 1,500 m to sea level today: 17°C at dawn, 31°C by dinner. Pack the jacket away at the bottom of the bag after this morning.

DAY 3

Mui Ne — white dunes at sunrise, red canyon after

Thursday, 10 September

START
05.00FINISH
~21.00SLEEP
Mui Ne (night 2)**Outfit:** Blue + yellow — sand, sky and sea all day

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
05.00	White Sand Dunes (Bàu Trắng) — sunrise ~35 km northeast, ~45 min Open in Google Maps	2.5h	The big pale dunes, and the only genuine desert in Vietnam. Go for sunrise: cool, empty, and the light is the whole point. Jeeps and quad bikes wait at the entrance — agree the price before you get in.
~07.45	Bàu Trắng lotus lake Beside the dunes Open in Google Maps	45 min	A freshwater lake right against the sand, fringed with lotus. The contrast of water, lotus and desert in one frame is the shot people come for.
~45 min back to Mui Ne			
~09.30	Breakfast back on the strip Ham Tien	1h	
~10.45	Fairy Stream (Suối Tiên) Ham Tien, off the main road Open in Google Maps	1.25h	Wade barefoot up a warm ankle-deep stream between red and white sandstone walls. Ten minutes in it opens into a small canyon. Leave the shoes at the entrance.
~12.15	Lunch Mui Ne	1h	
~13.30	Beach and pool — the hot hours Your resort	2.5h	This is the point of Mui Ne. Do nothing until four.
~16.15	Fishing village + Ông Địa rock beach Mui Ne village end Open in Google Maps	1.5h	Round blue coracle boats pulled up on the sand — the most photographed thing in Mui Ne after the dunes. Best in late afternoon when the fleet is in.
~18.00	Sunset on the beach + kite surfers Ham Tien strip	1h	Mui Ne is Vietnam's kite-surfing capital and the wind gets up late afternoon.
~19.30	Dinner Mui Ne	1.5h	

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- Two early starts in a row, then an afternoon doing nothing. That's the deal — the dunes are only good at the ends of the day.
- **Agree jeep and quad prices before starting**, and confirm whether the fee is per person or per vehicle.
- Sun here is much stronger than Da Lat: hat, sunscreen, water. Sand gets everywhere — leave the good camera bag in the room.

DAY 4

Down the expressway to Saigon

Friday, 11 September

START
08.00FINISH
~22.00SLEEP
Move → Saigon (night 4)**Outfit: Cream fairytale** — the colonial quarter and the café apartment

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
08.00	Slow morning — beach or pool Mui Ne	2h	No rush. The drive is short today.
~10.15	Checkout Mui Ne	30 min	
DRIVE: Mui Ne → Saigon on the Dầu Giây-Phan Thiết expressway — 200-220 km, 2.5-3 hours			
~13.45	Check in — District 1 Ben Thanh / Nguyen Hue area	45 min	Stay in District 1 and the whole afternoon is walkable.
~15.00	The Café Apartment, 42 Nguyễn Huệ Nguyen Hue walking street Open in Google Maps	2h	A nine-storey 1960s apartment block where every flat is now a café or a tiny shop, each with its own balcony over the street. Ride the lift to the top and work down — this is the cream-outfit location.
~17.15	Nguyễn Huệ walking street + Saigon Post Office District 1 Open in Google Maps	1.25h	The post office is Gustave Eiffel-era colonial iron and tiles, and still a working post office — send yourselves a postcard. Book Street is round the corner.
~18.45	Bến Thành Market + Saigon Square District 1 Open in Google Maps	1.5h	The last shopping of the trip. Bến Thành for souvenirs, Saigon Square for clothes and bags. Bargain hard — start at about 40%.
~20.30	Rooftop dinner District 1 Open in Google Maps	1.5h	Saigon does rooftops properly. Book one with a view down Nguyen Hue.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- The expressway has cut this drive to under three hours — it used to be five. Book a private car; the bus takes twice as long.
- Saigon in September is hot and wet, with a heavy shower most afternoons that clears in an hour. The café apartment and the market are both fine in rain.
- Pack tonight. Tomorrow is only a taxi ride and a flight.

Vietnam · Haris Haikal & Aina Izzaty · DAY 4 · times are estimates, shuffle freely

DAY 5

Fly home from Saigon

Saturday, 12 September

START 08.00	FINISH KUL	SLEEP —
Outfit: Khaki + black — travel day		

TIME	WHERE	HOW LONG	NOTES
08.00	Breakfast + last Vietnamese coffee District 1	1.5h	Cà phê sữa đá one more time. Buy beans on the way back if you didn't in Da Lat.
~10.30	Checkout District 1	30 min	
Hotel → Tan Son Nhat airport (SGN) — 8 km, 30-45 min in traffic			
~12.00	Check-in + immigration Tan Son Nhat T2 Open in Google Maps	2h buffer	International departures, Terminal 2. Saigon traffic is the variable, not the airport.
afternoon	SGN → KUL — Malaysia Airlines Tan Son Nhat T2	~2h	MH750 / MH758 / MH766. Malaysia is 1 hour ahead, so you land later on the clock than the flight time suggests.

NOTES FOR THE DAY

- **This is why the last night is in Saigon:** no domestic connection on the day you fly home. Just a taxi.
- Tan Son Nhat is inside the city — no long airport road, but the traffic getting there is real.

What one night in Da Lat costs you

The nine places off your list that didn't fit — and what to add if you find more time

PLACE	WHERE	WHY, AND WHEN TO SLOT IT IN
Euro Garden Cầu Đất Open in Google Maps	25 km southeast of Da Lat	The biggest loss. 7.2 ha at 1,650 m — flower fields, a miniature castle and Eiffel Tower, a railway café. If you ever add a Da Lat night, this is the one.
Lạc Hư Cổ Trấn + Miền Du Mục Open in Google Maps	Lâm Văn Thạnh rd, Xuân Trường	Both on the same road east: a Chinese ancient-town set, and a nomad tent café on a pine hill. A half-day for the pair — they'd pair with Euro Garden on one eastern day.
Pink Valley + Langbiang Open in Google Maps	Lạc Dương, 12–22 km north	Rose valley and the mountain, ten minutes apart. They sit on the road to Nha Trang, not the road to Mui Ne — which is why they fall out of this version.
Mongo Land + Floating Town Open in Google Maps	Tà Nung, 15–17 km southwest	Mongolian yurts, horses and archery; then wooden houses standing out of an emerald lake. Both on the western road, a half-day for the pair.
KDL Sinh Thái Cao Nguyên Hoa Open in Google Maps	Tà Nung area	Flower-highland eco park, next to the two above. Confirm hours locally — it's recent.
Happy Hill Open in Google Maps	Đá Tiên, Tuyen Lam lake, 12 km south	Film-set park with windmills and staged photo corners. Closes 17:30. Nearest of the lot to the road out.
Bàu Trắng lotus lake Open in Google Maps	Beside the White Dunes, Mui Ne	Already on Day 3 — lotus against desert sand, right where the jeeps drop you.
Kê Gà lighthouse + dragon fruit farms Open in Google Maps	~60 km southwest of Mui Ne	If you want one more Mui Ne outing: an 1890s lighthouse on an island you reach by boat, through miles of dragon-fruit trellises that get lit at night.
Mekong Delta day trip Open in Google Maps	From Saigon, ~2h each way	Only if you swap the Saigon night for two. Floating markets and — right now, in flood season — the pink water lilies.

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE

- One night in Da Lat buys you the dawn cloud hunt, the hydrangeas and the coaster. Everything above needs a second night.
- **If you do add a Da Lat night:** spend it on the eastern road — Euro Garden, Lạc Hư Cổ Trấn and Miền Du Mục in one day, no backtracking.
- Cao Nguyên Hoa and Miền Du Mục are both recent; re-confirm their hours locally before counting on them.